

Perx

The perks employees actually want, and the talent edge companies actually need — in one marketplace built for Albania and ready for the world.

The opportunity

Across Europe, companies reward their people with tax-efficient benefits — gym memberships, travel, courses, meals, wellness — funded as company credit rather than taxed salary. It is one of the most powerful levers a company has to attract and keep talent. In Albania the model is almost absent, and where benefit schemes exist anywhere, they tend to be dull: an employee logs in once a quarter, spends a budget out of obligation, and forgets the app exists.

This challenge is to build the marketplace that fixes both problems at once — giving employees benefits they genuinely want, and giving companies an easy, modern way to compete on what they offer their people. Build it so it could work in any country, but make it shine for Albania.

What you are building

A two-sided benefits marketplace with three actors:

- **Employees** browse the marketplace and choose the offers, deals, and packages they want.
- **Employers** fund and approve those choices.
- **Service providers** — gyms, travel agencies, restaurants, clinics, retailers, telecoms — list their offers and deals.

The core loop: an employee browses and selects one or more offers — a single deal or a package that may span several providers. The employer reviews and approves the selection, and payment goes directly to the relevant provider or providers. The employee enjoys the benefit; the money never passes through their hands.

A company can join the platform in either role — as an **employer** giving its people a welfare budget, or as a **provider** offering its services and deals to the marketplace (or both). Your app should make onboarding for each role clear and fast.

Make it international, win it in Albania

Architect the product so it is not locked to one country — think multiple languages, multiple currencies, and benefit categories that can be localized per market. Then prove it where it matters: design the primary experience around Albania, with local providers, Albanian Lek, and benefits that make sense here. The strongest solutions feel built for a Tirana employee today, yet could open in Milan or Madrid tomorrow without a rewrite.

Make it a habit, not a chore

Most benefit apps are opened once a quarter. Yours should be one people *want* to return to. Give them reasons: new deals worth checking, recommendations that feel personal, a sense of discovery, moments of delight. Engagement and stickiness are explicit goals of this challenge — treat "would I open this again next week?" as a question your design has to answer with yes.

Where AI comes in

AI should be part of the product, not an afterthought. Use it where it makes the experience smarter and more human — for example, personalized recommendations, a conversational way to find the right benefit, smart bundling of offers into packages, or insights for employers on what their people value. Using AI tools to accelerate your build is also welcome and encouraged. Show us AI that earns its place.

Directions to explore

Optional sparks — bring your own ideas and surprise us:

- An AI benefits concierge employees can simply talk to ("find me something relaxing under my budget")
- Gamified savings or wellness goals, streaks, and team challenges
- Social and group features — shared deals, team perks, gifting between colleagues
- Seasonal drops, limited-time offers, and a feed that is worth checking
- A personalized "year in benefits" style summary
- Smart packages that bundle complementary offers from several providers
- Employer-side insights: what is popular, what goes unused, what to add next

Scope and ground rules

You build everything from scratch — no datasets, APIs, or infrastructure are provided. Seed your own catalog of sample providers and offers, mock sample employers and employees, and simulate payments (no real payment rail is required). Favor a working core loop over breadth.

Minimum working demo: an employee browses, selects one or more offers (ideally a package spanning more than one provider), and submits the selection; an employer approves it; and the app routes a simulated payment to the relevant provider(s) and confirms the benefit — with at least one AI-driven or engagement feature shown live.

How you will be evaluated

Judging is transparent. Each submission is scored against the criteria below.

Criterion	Weight	What judges look for
Creativity & Innovation	45%	Originality and the "wow" factor. Does the idea make the benefits category feel fresh and exciting? Judges look for unexpected features, clever mechanics, and a concept that stands out rather than a predictable solution.
Experience & Working Prototype	35%	A polished, functional product after 48 hours. Judges look at both how good it feels to use — intuitive, delightful, sticky enough that people would reopen it regularly — and how much genuinely works. A live, robust demo beats slides full of promises.
Smart Use of AI	20%	Is AI integrated meaningfully — personalization, conversational discovery, smart bundling — and not just bolted on? Judges look for AI that genuinely enhances the creativity and the experience.